The Fourth Sheet

Example report · SMEs

SAMPLE DATA · invented figures for demonstration

Which products and services are growing?

Period: January 2026. Revenue, gross margin and growth (year on year) by product or service line over 24 months. Pick a line and every number, chart and note follows it.

How final is this data?

January 2026 Locked January 2026 is locked (closed 3 Feb 2026). These numbers won't change.

Services

Gross margin, not profit

Gross margin is not profit. Gross margin = revenue less contractors and consultant time charged to the work at $60 an hour (wages and all on-costs). Not included: consultant time not charged to clients, and overheads (management and admin wages, marketing, rent, IT, insurance, travel, depreciation, interest). Profit is what's left after those. Wages include their on-costs: super (12%) and leave as it's earned. No payroll tax: wages are under Queensland's $1.3 million threshold.

From gross margin to profit

January's client work made $69,830 gross margin (68.2%). Consultant time not charged to client work took $15,180 and overheads $51,360, leaving $3,290 profit before tax (3.2% of revenue). To cover overheads, client work needs a 65.0% gross margin on average.

Gross margin on client work	$69,830
Consultant wages and on-costs	$45,600
Consultant time charged to client work (at cost)	$30,420
Consultant time not charged to client work	$15,180
Gross profit (the P&L)	$54,650
Overheads (operating expenses, depreciation, interest)	$51,360
Profit before tax (the P&L)	$3,290
Revenue	$102,350
Gross margin on client work, %	68.2%
Profit before tax, % of revenue	3.2%
Gross margin client work need just to cover overheads and time not charged	**65.0%**

Type of work: All

January against January last year
6.0%
$102,350 against $96,560

Year to date (Jul to Jan 2026)
$578,275
same period last year: not in the data

Gross margin, year to date
67.5%
$390,095 before overheads

What it shows

Revenue is $578,275 this financial year to date (Jul to Jan 2026). Training makes the highest gross margin (77.9%); Projects the lowest (65.0%). The business needs 65.0% gross margin just to cover overheads.

What you'd do about it

Projects: 65.0% gross margin, 25.0 points over the 40.0% target ($89,665 ahead on $358,275 this financial year to date). Training: 77.9% gross margin, 37.9 points over the 40.0% target ($20,880 ahead on $55,100 this financial year to date).

Type of work: Projects

January against January last year
(8.4%)
$66,950 against $73,060

Year to date (Jul to Jan 2026)
$358,275
same period last year: not in the data

Gross margin, year to date
65.0%
$232,975 before overheads

What it shows

Projects brought in $358,275 this financial year to date, at a 65.0% gross margin (below the 67.5% overall).

What you'd do about it

Projects: 65.0% gross margin, 25.0 points over the 40.0% target ($89,665 ahead on $358,275 this financial year to date).

Type of work: Retainers

January against January last year
88.5%
$31,100 against $16,500

Year to date (Jul to Jan 2026)
$164,900
same period last year: not in the data

Gross margin, year to date
69.3%
$114,200 before overheads

What it shows

Retainers brought in $164,900 this financial year to date, at a 69.3% gross margin (above the 67.5% overall).

What you'd do about it

Retainers: 69.3% gross margin, 29.3 points over the 40.0% target ($48,240 ahead on $164,900 this financial year to date).

Type of work: Training

January against January last year
(38.6%)
$4,300 against $7,000

Year to date (Jul to Jan 2026)
$55,100
same period last year: not in the data

Gross margin, year to date
77.9%
$42,920 before overheads

What it shows

Training brought in $55,100 this financial year to date, at a 77.9% gross margin (above the 67.5% overall).

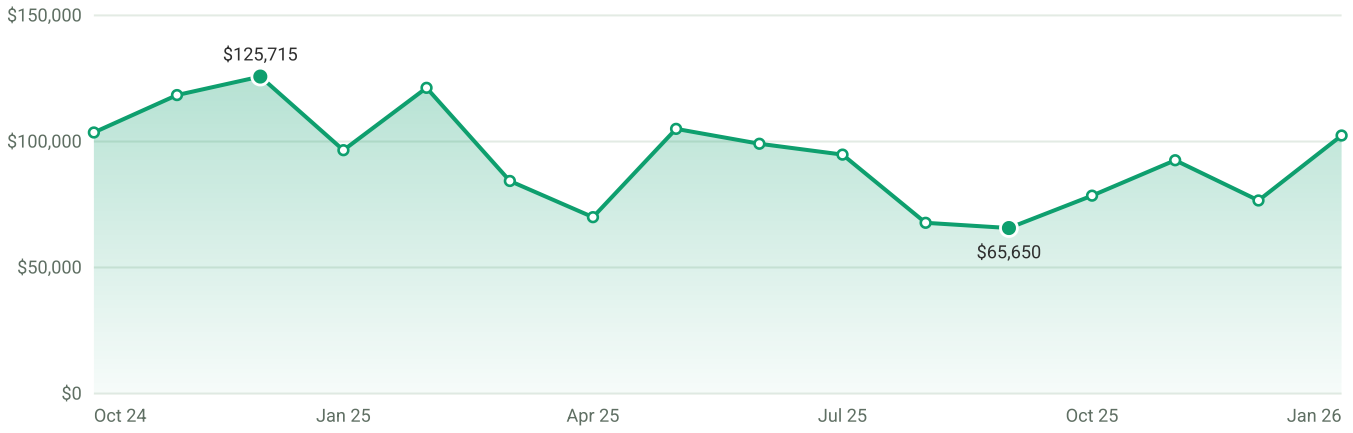
What you'd do about it

Training: 77.9% gross margin, 37.9 points over the 40.0% target ($20,880 ahead on $55,100 this financial year to date).

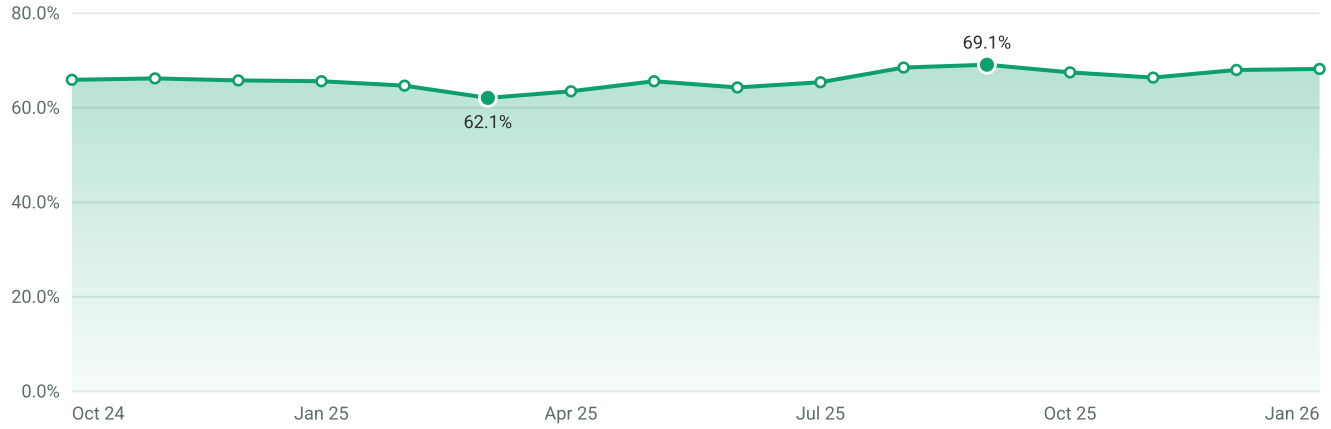
Every type of work at once

Revenue, gross margin and growth by type of work, by month

All · Revenue $



All · Gross margin %



Growth is year on year: each month against the same month a year earlier. Every month, by line, is in the spreadsheet download.

By type of work: financial year to date (Jul to Jan 2026) against the same period last year

	Year to date	Same period last year	Growth	Gross margin $	Gross margin %
Projects	$358,275	–	–	$232,975	65.0%
Retainers	$164,900	–	–	$114,200	69.3%
Training	$55,100	–	–	$42,920	77.9%
Total	$578,275	–	–	$390,095	67.5%

Same period last year: Not available: the data starts October 2024.

Made with Python: laid out in HTML and CSS, printed to PDF in Chromium.